"*Arbeitsbuch*," Katya read, "*Nadiya Solodowa*." One hand covered her mouth, while the other, with a slight tremor, held the card carefully.

"This was your mother's work permit issued in Germany," Rose said. "The photo was taken on the day she arrived—she was four months pregnant with you."

"I never knew her surname. Is the date her—"

"Birthday."

"January 18, 1925." Katya's voice quavered with emotion. "She was twenty years old when she had me." She shook her head. "She died so young." She pointed to a name written on the card, and read it aloud. "Odessa, USSR. That must have been where Maman came from. I never knew any of these things." Katya reached over and touched Rose's hand. "I'm so grateful for this. Thank you. I can't believe you've been carrying it around for more than forty years."

"I've been waiting." Rose paused. "To give it to you."

Despite dreading their reply, she took a breath and said, "Where's your mother? She's not coming, is she?"

Eve looked at Katya. "She's outside, across the street."

"Maman's afraid," Katya said.

Léa afraid? "Your mother's the bravest person I know. She was caught smuggling wine by the Germans and sent to an internment camp, and she delivered you not knowing what she was doing. Your mother isn't afraid of anything. She's just—" Rose stood "—overthinking." She picked up her cane and made for the door.

"Aunt Rose, I—"

Rose waved a hand in the air, cutting Eve off as she pulled open the door. The wind hit her. She'd left her coat back in the café. Never mind. She walked as quickly as she could to the end of the lane, leaning heavily on the cane for support. She was here to see her sister, and Léa was here too, so why on earth was she sitting on a bench outside?

* * *

Léa saw Rose across the street, one hand wedged in her skirt pocket, the other holding on to a cane. In the pit of her stomach, something large and heavy settled. Everything narrowed and magnified as if Léa was viewing